



Visa & Work Permits

China Visa Types Explained:

Which One Do You Need?

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China offers multiple visa categories. Choosing the right one depends on your purpose of visit. Here's a comprehensive breakdown.

L-Visa (Tourist)

For sightseeing, visiting friends/family. Duration: 30-90 days per entry. Single, double, or multiple entry options. Requirements: passport, application form, round-trip tickets, hotel booking or invitation letter.

M-Visa (Business/Trade)

For commercial activities, trade fairs, business meetings. Duration: 30-90 days. Multiple entry options available for frequent travelers. Requires invitation from Chinese trade partner or company.



X-Visa (Student)

X1:

For programs longer than 180 days. Must convert to residence permit within 30 days of arrival.

X2:

For programs shorter than 180 days. Valid for the enrollment period only.

Z-Visa (Work)

For employment in China. Requires Work Permit Notification from employer. Must convert to residence permit within 30 days. See our detailed Z-visa guide for the full process.

R-Visa (Talent)



For high-level foreign talent. Streamlined processing, longer validity (up to 10 years for some nationalities). Requires confirmation of high-level talent status.

Q-Visa (Family Reunion)

Q1:

Long-term (180+ days) for family of Chinese citizens/foreign residents.

Q2:

Short-term (up to 120 days) for visiting family.

S-Visa (Family of Foreign Workers)

For spouses, parents, and children of Z-visa holders working in China.

144-Hour Visa-Free Transit

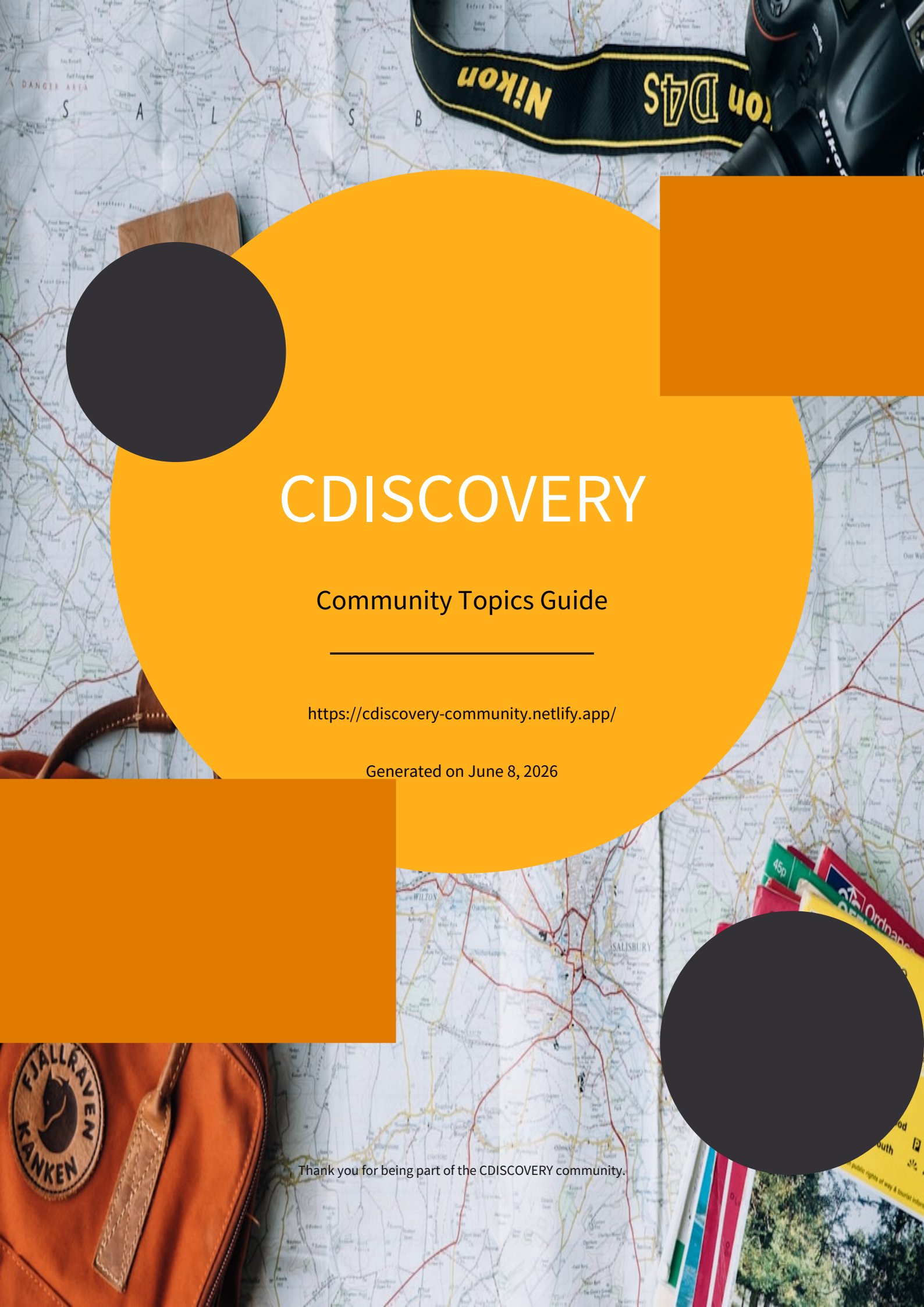
Available at major airports in Beijing, Shanghai, Guangzhou, Chengdu, and 20+ cities. For



citizens of 54 countries transiting through China. No visa needed if you have a confirmed
onward ticket to a third country.

Sources: Sources: [China Visa Online](http://www.visa.gov.cn) • [Ministry of Foreign Affairs](https://www.mfa.gov.cn)

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